

CHALLENGES AND OPPORTUNITIES ENCOUNTERED BY FARMERS
ASSOCIATION IN VICTORIAS CITY

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ABSTRACT

RICA MAE D. DIAZ and PAOLO B. LOQUINARIO of Central Philippines State University - Victorias Campus. June 2024. Challenges and Opportunities Encountered by Farmers Association in Victorias City.

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Farmers association is a group of individuals, who have undergone social preparation duly registered by any recognized government agencies with at least 75% of its members are engaged in agriculture related activities. There are challenges that the association are facing today. Having insufficient capital in association can result not having proper allocation of resources. The study was anchored on Nevitt Sanford (1966) theory of challenge and support, analyzing that for growth to occur, a person needs a balanced amount of challenge and support as appropriate for the task. This study aimed to determined the extent of challenges and opportunities encountered by farmers association in Victorias City. Descriptive-comparative research design was utilized, and probability sampling using the stratified random sampling was employed to identify participants who met the specified criteria. A self-made validated 50 item questionnaire was utilized in this study. The result of the study showed that the highest extent of challenges encountered by the farmers association was insufficient capital, highlighting their challenge faced which leads them to unable to start a business in association. Conversely, market access rank lower in terms of its challenge encountered by farmers association, suggesting that associations have a good connection to the market. On the other hand, it is evident that government support is a main opportunity which significantly encountered by farmers



association in Victorias City, highlighting that the government supports the association by giving them assistance where they can start their business in association. Conversely, farm ownership and operation loan rank lower in terms of opportunities encountered by farmers association, highlighting that associations are afraid to take risk in loans. The study found out that there was a significant difference on the challenges encountered by farmers association when grouped according to their profile. The result showed that farmers don't have correct contribution of their monthly dues since the association was not well-established on that situation the farmer association member cannot afford to distribute any amount of money. In addition to, the result showed that 11-15 years of existence of association suffered from lack of capital. This implies that 11-15 years of existence have insufficient capital, since they don't have proper collection of monthly dues caused by improper meetings in association. The result showed that there was a significant difference on the opportunities encountered by farmers association when grouped according to profile. This explains that not all typical farmers associations availed these incentives, since others are not fully aware on the incentives available to them or the procedures for accessing them. In accordance with this viewpoint, the researchers developed a training plan to be proposed in the locality to implement and execute the training plan in order to gain knowledge and to developed their characteristics as a member of the associations.